Ambu Bag



Category: **Medical, Healthcare & First Aid** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 7 labs

Covers these lab items: Ambu Bag; Ambu Bag with Mask (Adult); Ambu Mask (Adult); Resuscitator

What it is used for

An Ambu bag, also called a bag-valve-mask resuscitator, provides manual ventilation to a person who is not breathing adequately. It should be used by trained responders with appropriate airway support and emergency assistance.

Main parts

- Self-inflating bag provides manual airflow when squeezed.
- Patient valve directs airflow toward the patient and supports exhalation.
- Face mask forms a seal over the nose and mouth.
- Oxygen inlet and reservoir may supply additional oxygen on equipped models.
- Air intake valve allows the bag to refill after compression.
- Tubing connects compatible oxygen sources when required.
- Pressure relief or safety features may be included in some models.

Before you start

1. Call emergency services and activate the facility's emergency response procedure immediately.
2. Use the device only if trained in resuscitation and bag-mask ventilation.
3. Check responsiveness and breathing, and begin CPR when indicated by current training.
4. Inspect the bag, mask, valves, connectors, reservoir, and tubing for damage or obstruction.
5. Select an appropriate mask size and ensure oxygen supplies are available when indicated.
6. Use infection-control PPE and a suitable barrier where available without delaying urgent care.

How to use

1. Position the person and open the airway using the method appropriate to the situation and training.
2. Place the mask over the nose and mouth and obtain a secure seal.
3. Connect oxygen and the reservoir if indicated and compatible with the device.
4. Squeeze the bag smoothly to deliver only enough air for visible chest rise.
5. Allow the bag to refill fully between breaths and observe chest movement.
6. Ventilate at the rate and volume taught in current resuscitation training.
7. Watch for chest rise, air leaks, vomiting, or signs of airway obstruction.
8. If the chest does not rise, reposition the airway and mask and seek trained assistance.
9. Continue ventilation and CPR as indicated until normal breathing returns or emergency responders take over.

10. After use, dispose of single-use components and clean reusable parts according to infection-control instructions.

⚠ Safety

- Never use the device without appropriate training except as directed by an emergency dispatcher.
- Avoid excessive ventilation or forceful bag squeezing, which can cause harm.
- Ensure the mask seal and airway position are correct without pressing excessively on the face.
- Use oxygen safely and keep it away from flames, sparks, and oil or grease.
- Do not reuse single-use components or equipment that cannot be safely cleaned and disinfected.
- Do not delay emergency services, CPR, or defibrillator use when indicated.

Care & storage

- Check the bag, valves, mask, and connectors before each use according to the checklist.
- Clean and disinfect reusable components according to the manufacturer's instructions and facility policy.
- Store the complete device in a clean, dry, accessible emergency kit.
- Replace damaged, expired, or missing components and document inspection as required.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Squeezing the bag too forcefully or delivering breaths too quickly.
- Failing to create a mask seal or maintain an open airway.
- Ignoring absent chest rise or possible airway obstruction.
- Using contaminated, damaged, or expired equipment during an emergency.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.